“Conflict always ruins relationships.”

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Where it often comes from

If conflict in our home meant screaming, silence for days, or violence, we learned to avoid it at all costs. Some churches also teach that disagreement is a lack of unity. The result is surface peace and hidden resentment, and relationships that cannot handle honesty.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus taught, “If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over.” Paul says, “Speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ.” Proverbs says, “Better an open rebuke than love that is concealed. The wounds of a friend are faithful,” and “the tongue of the wise brings healing.” Jesus said, “First go and be reconciled to your brother.” Handled well, conflict can strengthen relationships. Avoiding it can quietly erode them.

> *“Better an open rebuke than love that is concealed. The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful”* (Proverbs 27:5–6).

Also see

> “If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over” (Matthew 18:15).

> “Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head” (Ephesians 4:15).

> “Speaking rashly is like a piercing sword, but the tongue of the wise brings healing” (Proverbs 12:18).

> “So if you are offering your gift at the altar and there remember that your brother has something against you, leave your gift there before the altar. First go and be reconciled to your brother; then come and offer your gift” (Matthew 5:23–24).

Common self-statements

- If we disagree, it is over.
- Peace means never arguing.
- I must avoid conflict at all costs.
- If I bring it up, it will explode.
- Good relationships have no conflict.
- Silence is safer.

Common logical errors

- Catastrophizing: Imagining that any conflict will destroy the relationship.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing relationships are either conflict-free or broken.
- Fortune telling: Predicting an explosion.
- Should statements: Insisting that good relationships should have no tension.

Challenging questions

- What did conflict look like in my family?
- Have I seen a disagreement handled well? What made the difference?
- What do I lose by avoiding hard conversations?
- What would a calm, respectful way of raising an issue look like?
- What does Scripture say about speaking the truth in love?
- Is any conflict in my life unsafe, requiring outside help?

Truth summary

> Conflict handled with respect can strengthen relationships. I can speak the truth in love, listen, and work toward reconciliation. Where conflict is unsafe, I can seek help and protect myself.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Communication
- Argumentative
- Anger
- Peace
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Anger

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Conflict always ruins relationships"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Conflict always ruins relationships." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did conflict look like at home?
- ☐ What have I seen done well?
- ☐ What does avoiding cost?
- ☐ How can I raise an issue gently?
- ☐ Is it safe?
- ☐ Who can help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The wounds of a friend are faithful.
- ☐ I can speak the truth in love.
- ☐ Reconciliation is possible.
- ☐ The tongue of the wise brings healing.
- ☐ Avoidance has costs.
- ☐ I can seek help if it is unsafe.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 27:5–6**
  "Better an open rebuke than love that is concealed. The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful."
- ☐ **Matthew 18:15**
  "If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over."
- ☐ **Ephesians 4:15**
  "Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Truth in love: Each week, note one issue you raised respectfully and what happened.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ephesians 4:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can speak the truth in love.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Communication" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Choose a small issue. Practice on a low-stakes topic.
- [ ] Use a gentle start. Begin with "I feel... when... I would like..."
- [ ] Listen first. Ask the other person to share their view.
- [ ] Seek help if needed. If conflict involves threats or violence, call 911 or seek counseling.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Conflict always ruins relationships": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Truth in love
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Conflict always ruins relationships.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, conflict frightens me. Teach me to speak the truth in love, to listen well, and to seek reconciliation. Protect me where it is unsafe. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.